

Unlocking athlete potential through Sports Science and Data

During a panel discussion on 'Unlocking athlete potential through Sports Science and Data', Dr. G. Kishore, Principal and Regional Director-SAI, Lakshmibai National College of Physical Education, Thiruvananthapuram, stressed the importance of incorporating sports science at the grassroots level.

"At the top level, athletes under SAI, especially those under TOPS or the National Centre of Excellence, are being scientifically monitored and data analytics is being done. But, at the developmental level and the grassroots level, it hasn't percolated as desired," he said.

Harendra Singh, head coach of the Indian women's hockey team, also batted for the development of science and data in sports.

"After 28 years in the coaching circle, I can say that, if you impart science, you can achieve the target. It's not the skill only that is going to win you a medal. Sports science plays a vital role if you want to enhance

performance and achieve a medal at the top level."

Dr. Kishore added that systems have to be implemented in the local tiers to familiarise athletes.

"It is difficult to convince the athletes who consider it an additional burden. [With data analytics] each athlete will develop inquisitiveness to know where he stands and he can himself progress," he said.

"Nowadays, around the world, they have athlete management systems with a repository of data. SAI has also established a National Sports Repository System (NSRS) and an Athlete Management System, where each athlete's performance can be monitored," he added.

Dr. Pralay Majumdar, Senior Advisor, Centre of Excellence in Sports Science and Analytics, IIT Madras, reckoned that more had to be done in the field of biomechanics.

"We need to do a lot of work to improve the system in sports biomechanics due to a lack of resources and a lack of understanding by coaches dealing with the techniques and tactics in individual sports."



From right: Dr. G. Kishore (Principal and Regional Director- SAI, Lakshmibai National College of Physical Education, Thiruvananthapuram), Dr. Pralay Majumdar (Sr. Advisor, Centre of Excellence in Sports Science and Analytics, IIT Madras) and Harendra Singh (Head Coach, Indian women's hockey team) during the Conclave. R. V. MOORTHY